

Panchmeshali Platform — Development Documentation

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1. Platform Overview

Panchmeshali is a Bengali literary community platform for writers, readers, and publishers. It includes:

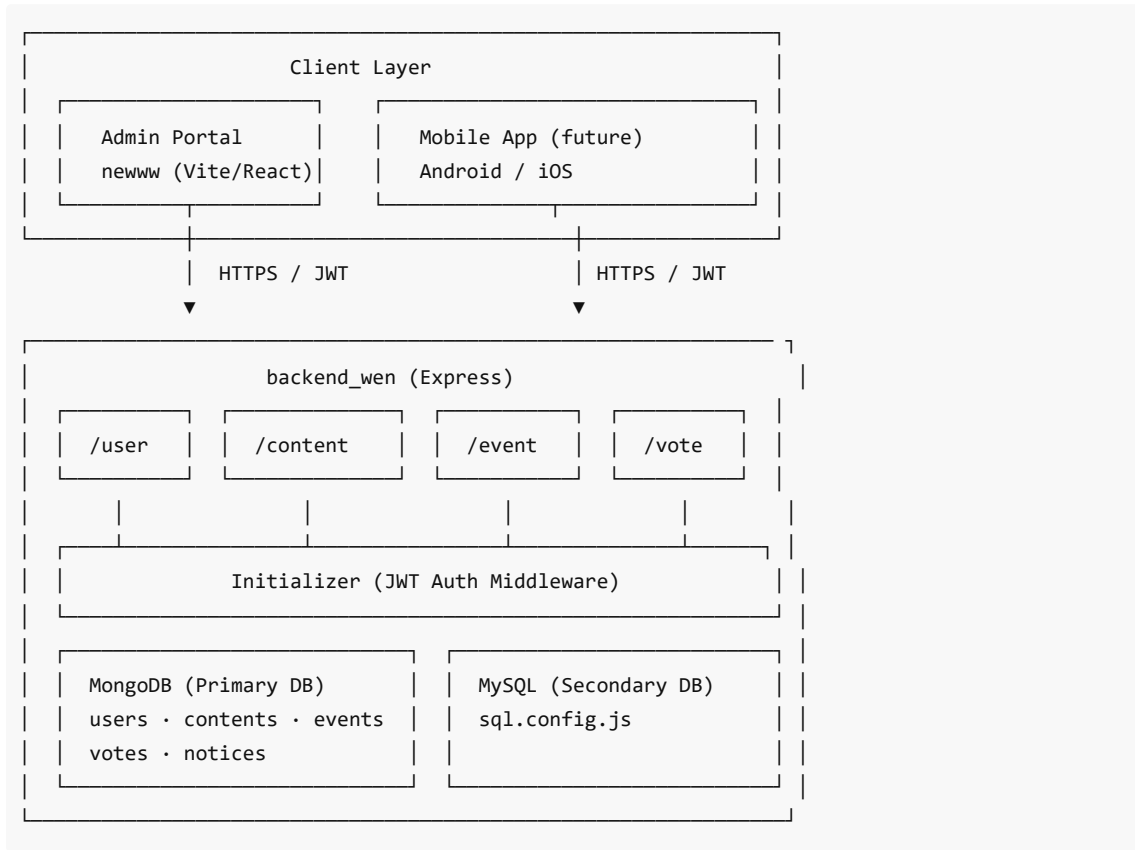
Component	Stack	Role
backend_wen	Node.js · Express · MongoDB · MySQL	REST API server
newww	Vite · React 19 · TypeScript	Admin Portal (web)
Mobile App (<i>planned</i>)	Android / iOS	Writer-facing mobile app

The platform enables:

- Writers to **submit stories, poems, and episodes** for events or general publication
- Admins to **review, mark, and publish** submitted content
- Community **voting** on shortlisted content
- **Event management** — writing competitions, book challenges, episode-wise contests
- **Real-time chat** between admins and writers

- **Certificate** generation for winners and participants

2. System Architecture



3. Backend — backend_wen

3.1 Tech Stack

Library	Version	Purpose
Express	^4.x	HTTP server and routing
Mongoose	^8.x	MongoDB ODM
MySQL2	^3.x	MySQL/MariaDB driver
Passport.js	^0.7	Google OAuth 2.0 strategy
JSON Web Token	^9.x	Stateless authentication
Nodemailer	^6.x	Transactional email
Multer	^1.x	File upload handling
Joi	^17.x	Request body validation
express-rate-limit	^7.x	API rate limiting

Swagger UI Express	^5.x	Auto-generated API docs
bcrypt	^5.x	Password hashing
moment	^2.x	Date/time formatting

3.2 Server Bootstrap

`app.js` contains the `Server` class which bootstraps in 4 phases:

Phase 1 – Middlewares

`CORS` · `rate-limit` · `express-session` · `Passport init` · `body-parser`

Phase 2 – Database

`SetupDatabase()` → MongoDB connection

`sql.config.js` → MySQL connection pool

Phase 3 – Routes

`/api/v1/*` → `Route.js` → [`UserRoutes`, `ContentRoutes`, `EventRoutes`, `VotingRoutes`]

Phase 4 – Listen

`app.listen(PORT)`

3.3 Database Connections

MongoDB (Primary)

- **Connection:** `mongoose.connect()` via `SetupDatabase()` in `database/`
- **Collections:** `users`, `contents`, `events`, `votes`, `noticesadmins`
- **Models:** all defined in `models/monogdb/`

MySQL (Secondary)

- **Connection:** `mysql2.createPool()` in `sql.config.js`
- **Use:** supplementary relational data and analytics queries

3.4 Authentication & Role System

All protected routes pass through `Initializer.js` :

```
Request header: Authorization: Bearer <JWT>
→ jwt.verify(token)
→ DB lookup: users.findOne({ uid })
→ Role check: user.role ∈ requiredRoles[]
→ next() or 401/403
```

Role	Level	Access
super_admin	0	Full system access
admin	1	Content, events, users
author	2	Own content submission only
reader	3	Read + vote only

JWT Payload:

```
{ "uid": "user_unique_id", "email": "user@example.com", "role": "admin" }
```

3.5 API Modules

User Module (/api/v1/)

Method	Path	Auth	Description
GET	/auth/google	—	Initiate Google OAuth flow
GET	/auth/google/callback	—	Google OAuth callback
POST	/login	—	Email/password login, returns JWT
POST	/register	—	New user registration
GET	/profile	JWT	Get current user profile
PUT	/profile	JWT	Update profile info
POST	/forgot_password	—	Send password reset email
POST	/reset_password	—	Confirm password reset
GET	/users	Admin	List all users
DELETE	/user/:uid	Admin	Delete/deactivate user

Content Module (/api/v1/)

Method	Path	Auth	Description
POST	/submit_contents	JWT	Submit story/poem/episode
GET	/contents	JWT	Paginated content list (filter by status, event, type)
GET	/notices	JWT	Fetch published notices
GET	/certificates	JWT	Fetch winner certificates
PUT	/add_marks	Admin	Admin marks/scores a submission
POST	/create_notice	Admin	Create and email a notice to writers

Content submission validation (ContentValidator middleware) checks:

- event_id , content_title , content , is_original are present
- Date: event must be currently active (st_dt ≤ now ≤ en_dt)
- Participation: if parent event exists, user must have participated in it
- Duplicate: user cannot submit to the same event twice

Event Module (/api/v1/)

Method	Path	Auth	Description
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GET	/events	Admin	Hierarchical event tree (recursive nesting by parent)
GET	/events_list	JWT	Flat event list for writers
POST	/create_event	Admin	Create new event
PUT	/update_event/:eid	Admin	Update event fields
DELETE	/delete_event/:eid	Admin	Soft-delete event

Event Schema fields:

Field	Type	Description
name	String	Event name
description	String	Full description
active	Boolean	Is event currently open
episode_wise	Boolean	Enables episode-by-episode submission
for_book	Boolean	Enables multi-episode book write mode
categories	Array	Allowed content categories
st_dt / en_dt	Timestamp	Start / end dates
parent	String	Parent event ID (for hierarchical events)
w_count	Number	Max word count per submission
sh_list	Number	Shortlist threshold
type	String	"vote" Or "judge"

Voting Module (/api/v1/)

Method	Path	Auth	Description
GET	/vote_list	JWT	Paginated list of contents for voting
GET	/top_votes	JWT	Leaderboard of top-voted submissions
POST	/vote	JWT	Cast a vote for a content item

Voting rules enforced in `VotingController` :

- One vote per user per content item per event
- Vote is stored with `uid` , `cont_id` , `eid` in the `votes` collection
- `top_votes` uses MongoDB aggregation pipeline to count and rank

3.6 Email System

Transport: Nodemailer with SMTP credentials from `.env`

Used in:

- **Password Reset** — sends reset link to user email
- **Notice Broadcasting** — admin creates a notice via `POST /create_notice` ; the controller fetches all registered writer emails and sends the notice as an HTML email using a custom template

3.7 File Uploads

Library: Multer
Usage: Profile picture and content image uploads
Storage: local disk (configurable to cloud storage in production)

3.8 Swagger Docs

Auto-generated API documentation accessible at:

```
GET /api-docs
```

Defined in `swagger.js` using `swagger-ui-express` and `swagger-jsdoc` .

4. Admin Portal — newww

4.1 Tech Stack

Layer	Tool
Bundler	Vite 7
UI	React 19 + TypeScript 5.9
Routing	TanStack Router
Data Fetching	TanStack Query
Global State	Jotai
Styling	Tailwind CSS 4
Rich Text	Tiptap (@tiptap/react, @tiptap/starter-kit)
Animations	Framer Motion
Icons	Lucide React
Validation	Zod

4.2 Features Built

- Dashboard (/)**
- Overview statistics cards (total submissions, active events, pending reviews)
 - Quick navigation links to all major sections
- Content List (/content)**
- Paginated list of submitted content
 - Filter by status: `All` , `Pending` , `Approved` , `Rejected` , `Under Review`
 - Each card shows: title, type badge, status badge, author, word count

Content Detail (/content/\$id)

- Full content view with rendered HTML body
- Comment thread — displays existing comments; admin can add new comments
- AI quality check button (checkQualityAI) — mocked, returns score + feedback
- AI proofreader button (proofreadAI) — mocked, returns corrections

Chat (/chats)

- Admin–writer messaging interface
- Sidebar list of open chats with unread count indicators
- Message thread with timestamps, sent/received alignment

Users (/users)

- User list with search
- Create new user / ban user / remove user
- Send email to individual writer via modal

Settings (/settings)

- Application configuration panel

4.3 Submission Wizard (/submit)

Two independent multi-step wizards on the same page, toggled by tabs:

Content Submission Wizard (4 steps)

Step	Label	Key Fields	Next Gate
0	Destination	Submission type, Publisher	Publisher required if new
1	Details	Story Title, Content Type, Category	Title + Type + Category required
2	Write	Content (RichTextEditor), Background Image (16:9), Cover Image (9:16), Destination	—
3	Review	Original authorship checkbox	Must confirm to submit

Event Submission Wizard (3 steps)

Step	Label	Key Fields	Next Gate
0	Event	Event selector	Event must be selected
1	Write	Content (episode or single mode)	—
2	Review	Original authorship checkbox	Must confirm to submit

Episode / Book Mode (controlled by Event flags)

episode_wise	for_book	Write Step Behaviour
false	false	Single content title + editor
true	false	Single editor; adds "Add next episode" to submission type

true	true	One episode card pre-rendered; "Add episode" button appends more cards with individual remove buttons
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Form Validation (useSubmissionForm + Zod schema)

- Publisher required when newSubmission === 'new' and not an event
- Category required when newSubmission === 'new'
- Episode number required when newSubmission === 'Add next episode'
- Image uploads validated for aspect ratio (± 0.05 tolerance):
 - Background image: **16:9**
 - Cover image: **9:16**

On Successful Submission

1. API call: POST /submit_contents
2. Toast notification shown
3. **Auto-save to Workspace:** a new WorkspaceFile is prepended to workspaceFilesAtom in the root folder, containing the full title, HTML content, category, publisher, event name, and status 'Pending'

4.4 Workspace (/workspace)

Google Drive-inspired file browser for organising submitted content.

Folder Operations

Action	Description
Create Folder	Modal; random colour assigned; added to workspaceFoldersAtom
Rename Folder	Modal; updates name + modifiedAt
Delete Folder	Blocked if folder contains children or files

File Operations

Action	Available For
Upload	All file types (pdf, doc, docx, txt)
Download	Non-content files only (pdf, docx, txt)
Share	All files — opens email share modal
Delete	All files — confirmation dialog
Preview	Story / Poem files — opens Content Preview Modal

File Card Display

Type	Icon	Colour	Extra Display
story	BookOpen	Purple	Badge · Excerpt · "Click to preview" hover
poem	BookOpen	Pink	Badge · Excerpt · "Click to preview" hover

pdf	FileText	Red	—
docx/doc	FileText	Blue	—
txt	FileText	Grey	—

Content Preview Modal (`ContentPreviewModal.tsx`)

Mobile layout: Full-screen bottom sheet sliding up from bottom; drag handle at top.

Desktop layout: Centred rounded modal, max 90vh.

View Mode:

- Renders full HTML content body (`.prose` container)
- Metadata grid: Type · Category · Publisher · Author · Event · Submitted · Updated · Size
- Mobile: metadata is a collapsible accordion

Edit Mode:

- Activated by "Edit" button (header on desktop; footer on mobile)
- Body: **RichTextEditor** (Tiptap — Bold, Italic, Heading, Lists, Blockquote, Undo/Redo)
- Editable fields: Title · Author · Category · Publisher · Event Name
- Dropdowns: Type (`story/poem/doc/txt/pdf`) · Status (`Pending/Reviewing/Approved/Rejected`)
- Mobile: separate sticky "Cancel / Save changes" action bar below header
- Save: writes to `workspaceFilesAtom`, recomputes `excerpt`
- Cancel: discards all draft changes

Seed Data

A demo story "**The Lost Kingdom**" is seeded in the workspace root with full content, category (Fantasy), publisher, author, and excerpt pre-filled.

4.5 Event Management (`/events`)

- **List view** — searchable, shows all events in card grid
- **Create event form** — includes:
 - Name, Description, Start date, End date
 - Word count limit, Shortlist count
 - Categories multi-select
 - Toggle: **Event is Active**
 - Toggle: **Episode Wise** (`episode_wise` flag)
 - Toggle: **For Book** (`for_book` flag)
- Submitting the form calls `createEvent()` which adds to mock storage and invalidates the `events` query

4.6 User Management (`/users`)

- Paginated user list with search
- **Create User** modal — name, email, role
- **Ban User** action — sets status to `'banned'`
- **Remove User** action — deletes from store
- **Send Email** modal — compose and send to individual writer

4.7 Voting System

Voting is managed via the backend. Admin portal surfaces:

- Voting leaderboard from `GET /top_votes`
- Vote status per content item (has the current user voted?)

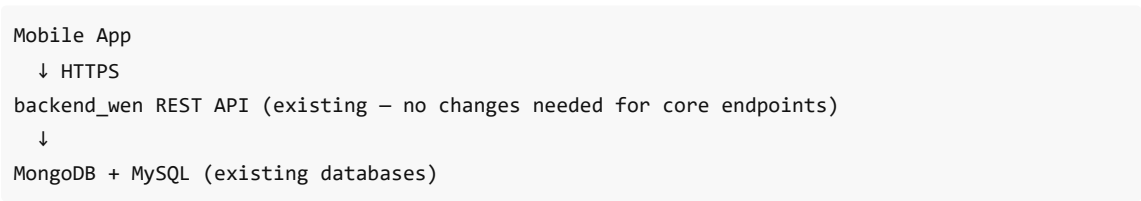
5. Future Roadmap — Android / iOS Integration

The backend API is already REST-based and JWT-authenticated, making it **ready to serve a mobile app** without any core changes.

5.1 Planned Mobile App Features

Feature	Details
Writer Registration & Login	Google OAuth + email/password via existing <code>/login</code> , <code>/register</code> endpoints
Content Submission	Writers submit stories/poems/episodes from the app directly to <code>POST /submit_contents</code>
Event Discovery	Browse active events, see deadlines and categories
Episode-wise Writing	In-app Tiptap-like editor supporting multi-episode book submission
Voting	Community members vote on shortlisted content via <code>POST /vote</code>
Notifications	Push notifications (FCM) for submission approvals, notices, new events
Certificate Download	Download participation/winner certificates via <code>GET /certificates</code>
Admin Chat	Writers can message admins and receive replies
Profile Management	View + edit profile, upload avatar via <code>PUT /profile</code>

5.2 Integration Plan



New backend additions required for mobile:

Addition	Description
FCM Push Notifications	<code>firebase-admin</code> SDK; store FCM tokens in <code>users</code> collection
Refresh Token endpoint	<code>POST /refresh_token</code> for long-lived mobile sessions
File upload to cloud	Replace local Multer storage with S3/Cloudinary for user-uploaded images
Rate limiting per device	Extend <code>express-rate-limit</code> with device fingerprinting

App version gate	Middleware to reject outdated app versions
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5.3 Tech Recommendations for Mobile

Layer	Recommendation
Framework	React Native (Expo) — shares TypeScript types and API layer with the admin portal
Navigation	Expo Router (file-based routing, mirrors TanStack Router pattern)
State	Jotai (same library already used in admin portal)
Data Fetching	TanStack Query (same library already used in admin portal)
Rich Text Input	@10play/tiptap-editor (React Native Tiptap wrapper)
Push Notifications	Expo Notifications + Firebase Cloud Messaging
Auth Token Storage	expo-secure-store for JWT storage on device

6. Changelog

March 2026

Date	Change	Files Affected
08 Mar	ContentPreviewModal — edit mode with RichTextEditor for all fields	ContentPreviewModal.tsx
08 Mar	ContentPreviewModal — mobile-responsive bottom sheet layout	ContentPreviewModal.tsx
08 Mar	FileGrid — story/poem cards open preview instead of download	FileGrid.tsx
08 Mar	useSubmissionForm — auto-save submission to workspace root	useSubmissionForm.ts
08 Mar	WorkspaceFile type extended with fullContent, excerpt, category, publisher, author, status, eventName	types/workspace.ts
08 Mar	Seeded demo story ("The Lost Kingdom") in workspace root	store/atoms.ts
08 Mar	Events.tsx — added episode_wise and for_book toggle switches to event creation form	routes/Events.tsx
08 Mar	Submit.tsx — episode/book mode UI based on event flags	routes/Submit.tsx
08 Mar	Submit.tsx — Next button disabled until required step fields are filled	routes/Submit.tsx

08 Mar	Submit.tsx — Publisher required gate for Content → New Submission	routes/Submit.tsx
08 Mar	Documentation — README_Writers.md created (frontend reference)	docs/README_Writers.md
08 Mar	Documentation — README_Backend.md created (backend reference)	docs/README_Backend.md
08 Mar	Documentation — DEVELOPMENT.md created (this file)	docs/DEVELOPMENT.md

Document maintained by the Panchmeshali development team. For questions, raise an issue on the repository or contact the lead developer.